ENGLISH / BC GRADE 10 / 11 / 12

From quotation to analysis

Explain how a writer's choices create meaning.

Literary Studies / English Studies · shared skill

01 Make an arguable claim

A literary claim interprets a detail rather than merely reporting the plot. Connect a technique, such as imagery or contrast, to a particular effect or idea.

02 Choose precise evidence

Select the smallest useful passage. Introduce its context and cite it in the format your teacher requests. Distinguish the narrator or speaker from the real author.

03 Explain the language

Zoom in on a word, image, or pattern. Explain how it supports your interpretation. Acknowledge ambiguity when the text permits more than one reasonable reading.

Worked example

Original miniature text: "She folded the acceptance letter until it fit inside her closed fist."

Possible analysis: The contrast between an acceptance letter and a closed fist suggests tension rather than simple celebration. The physical act of folding the letter makes the opportunity seem constrained, supporting a reading of uncertainty or resistance. This is an interpretation, not the only possible answer.

Watch out: Naming a device is not enough. Explain what the specific language does in this particular passage.

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Try it. Then check it.

Work through these questions before looking at the answers.

1. Write a claim about the miniature text above.

2. Select two words that help support your claim.

3. Give a different plausible interpretation and explain what evidence it uses.

Answer key

1. Possible claim: The character's gesture suggests discomfort with the opportunity she has received.

2. "Closed fist" can suggest resistance or contained emotion; "folded" emphasizes a deliberate physical action. Connect the words to your own claim.

3. Another reading: she holds the letter tightly because it is precious. That reading uses the close physical grip, but should acknowledge that "fist" can also sound tense.

One-minute recap

Close the notes. Explain one key idea in your own words, then retry the question you found most difficult.

About this guide

Original Study Bridge topic review prepared with AI assistance. Suggested course fit, not complete or official course coverage. Compare with your teacher's materials. Examples and practice questions are newly written.

Official course context: Literary Studies / English Studies · shared skill

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